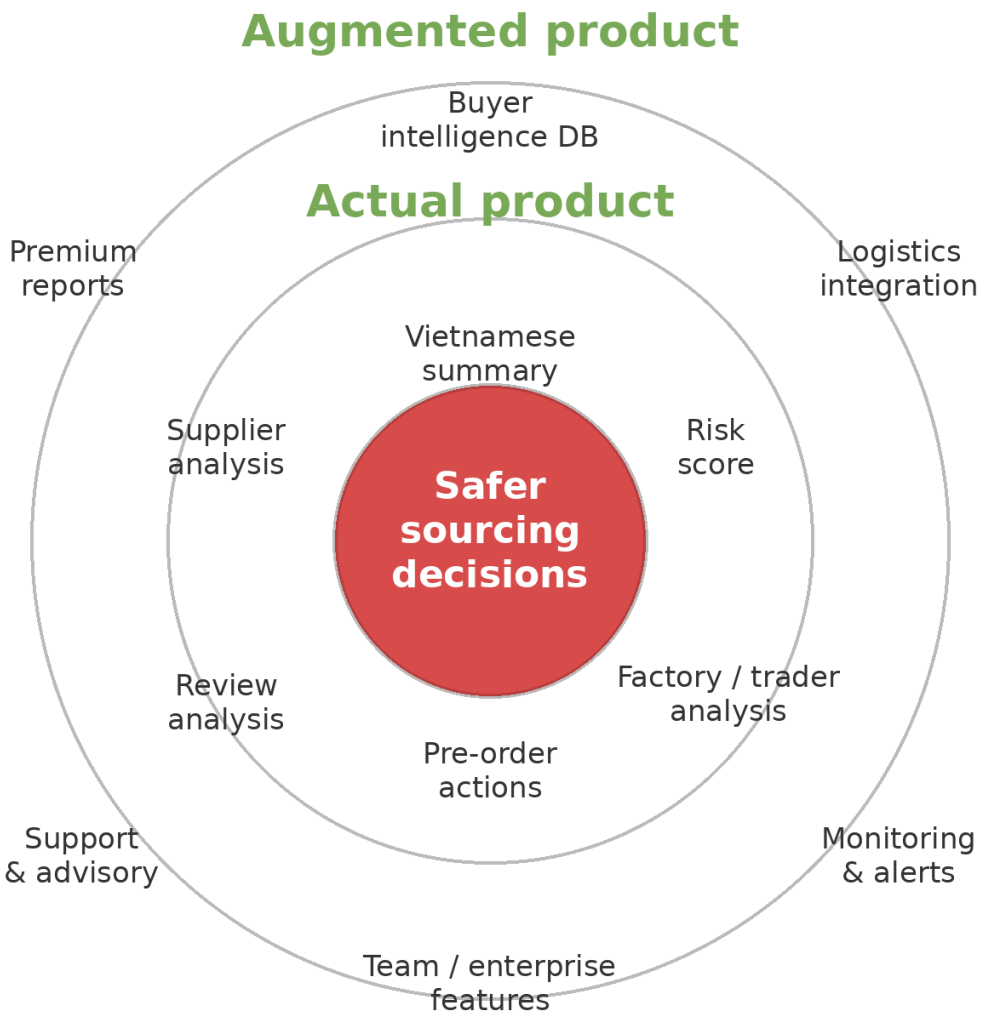
VCT CONNECT
DISTILLED PRODUCT MODEL

Core Customer Value - Actual Product - Augmented Product

Overview. This note rewrites the project in a more distilled form, following the three-level product model. The focus is to identify the core value received by the customer, the visible product delivered to the market, and the additional layers that strengthen the product over time.

Figure 1. Distilled product model for VCT Connect



The figure summarises the relationship between the customer value at the centre, the core product functions, and the augmented services that increase trust, retention, and long-term differentiation.

1. Core Customer Value

The core customer value represents the fundamental benefit that the buyer is actually seeking. In this case, customers are not primarily purchasing artificial intelligence, translation tools, dashboards, or a supplier score. They are purchasing greater confidence and lower risk when selecting a Chinese supplier.

Therefore, the core customer value can be summarised as follows: to help Vietnamese sellers and SMEs make safer sourcing decisions before placing an order with a Chinese supplier.

- Reduce the risk of choosing the wrong supplier before money is transferred or a bulk order is placed.
- Lower the chance of poor product quality, wrong specifications, delayed delivery, and unreliable after-sales support.
- Protect working capital, reduce the risk of deposit loss, and avoid unnecessary sourcing mistakes.
- Protect the seller's reputation by reducing the chance of receiving inventory that later creates customer complaints and negative reviews.
- Save time by reducing the need for manual translation, manual review reading, and guesswork in supplier verification.

> *In short, the project exists to reduce sourcing risk, improve decision confidence, and better protect both business capital and business reputation.*

2. Actual Product

The actual product refers to the visible and usable solution delivered to customers. In this project, the actual product is VCT Connect, a Vietnamese-first supplier-risk intelligence platform that is accessible through a Web App and a Chrome Extension.

From a customer perspective, the product workflow is simple: the user inputs a supplier or product link from 1688, Taobao, or Alibaba; the platform extracts and analyses available information; and the system returns an explainable Vietnamese risk report before the order is placed.

2.1 Main functions of the actual product

- Supplier analysis: extraction of supplier details, operating history, product categories, transaction indicators, ratings, pricing signals, review content, and delivery-related information.
- Vietnamese supplier summary: contextual explanation of Chinese supplier information in clear Vietnamese, rather than literal translation only.
- Supplier risk score: an explainable risk assessment supported by evidence, with categories such as low risk, moderate risk, high risk, or insufficient information.

- Factory versus trading-company analysis: a confidence-based estimate of whether the supplier is more likely to be a direct manufacturer or a trading company.
- Review and complaint analysis: identification of repeated complaint themes and unusual review patterns that may indicate hidden product or credibility problems.
- Pre-order recommendations: practical actions for the buyer to take before placing an order, such as confirming specifications, requesting proof, or placing a small test order.

2.2 Distilled definition of the actual product

The actual product can therefore be summarised as follows: a browser-based and web-based platform that analyses Chinese suppliers, explains risk in Vietnamese, and provides evidence-based recommendations before ordering.

3. Augmented Product

The augmented product includes the additional services, support systems, and long-term assets that extend the platform beyond the basic automated report. These elements are important because they increase trust, strengthen retention, and create competitive differentiation over time.

3.1 Main elements of the augmented product

- Human-reviewed premium reports for higher-value orders, combining AI output with manual verification by a knowledgeable reviewer.
- A Vietnamese buyer intelligence database that records supplier experiences, complaint patterns, and verified sourcing outcomes from the local market.
- Logistics and intermediary integration, allowing the platform to work alongside existing import, sourcing, and shipping workflows.
- Supplier monitoring and alerts, so that saved suppliers can be tracked for meaningful changes in ratings, review sentiment, prices, or complaint patterns.
- Category-specific risk models that improve relevance for industries such as fashion, cosmetics, electronics, homeware, or accessories.
- Team and enterprise features such as shared supplier records, internal comments, approval workflows, dashboards, and API access.
- Support and advisory services to help customers interpret reports and make better sourcing decisions in more complex or higher-risk situations.
- Transparency and accuracy controls, including confidence levels, visible evidence sources, data freshness, and mechanisms for user feedback and correction.

3.2 Distilled definition of the augmented product

The augmented product can therefore be summarised as follows: a broader supplier-intelligence ecosystem built around verification, monitoring, local market knowledge, workflow support, and customer trust.

4. Final Summary

Level	Distilled definition
Core customer value	Safer sourcing decisions with lower risk, higher confidence, and better protection of capital and reputation.
Actual product	A Web App and Chrome Extension that turns 1688, Taobao, and Alibaba links into explainable Vietnamese supplier-risk reports.
Augmented product	A growing supplier-intelligence layer that adds premium verification, buyer intelligence, monitoring, integrations, team functions, and support.

Overall conclusion. If the project is expressed in its most concise form, VCT Connect is not simply an AI tool for supplier checking. It is a Vietnamese supplier-risk intelligence product whose central promise is to help buyers choose more safely before they commit money to a Chinese supplier. The Web App and Chrome Extension form the actual product, while the verification, monitoring, intelligence, and support layers form the augmented product.